

A Quarto Paper Example

Title, Abstract, Footnotes, Citations, and a Figure

Boris Shor

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Abstract

This short example shows how a Quarto document can be written as a paper rather than as a slide deck, dashboard, or textbook chapter. It includes a title block, abstract, section headings, footnotes, citations, a local bibliography file, and a small figure generated from data stored inside the `Demos` folder.

1 Introduction

Agenda control concerns the ability to shape what receives consideration, what is delayed, and what is kept off the floor. A central claim in the congressional parties literature is that majority parties can function as agenda cartels, using procedural power to protect members from votes that would damage the party brand (Cox and McCubbins 1993, 2005).

The same broad question travels well beyond Congress. State legislatures vary across institutions, over time, and across majority parties. That variation makes them useful for thinking about when agenda control is strong, weak, or uneven.¹

2 Measurement

One way to measure agenda control is to focus on outcomes. Jenkins and Monroe (2016) describe a four-part typology based on whether the majority party supports a measure and whether the measure passes. A majority roll occurs when a measure opposed by most majority-party members passes anyway. A majority block occurs when such a measure fails. The two positive-agenda analogues are successes and disappointments.

This outcome-focused approach is helpful for cross-institutional comparison because it does not require every chamber to use identical procedural tools.

¹Footnotes are useful for short qualifications that would interrupt the flow of the main text. They should not become a second paper running beneath the first one.

Institutional rules still matter, of course. For example, committee gatekeeping and calendar control can change whether disfavored measures ever reach a floor vote (Anzia and Jackman 2013).

3 A Small Reproducible Figure

The figure below is not from the agenda-control paper. It is included to show how a paper can combine prose, citations, dynamically calculated values, and a locally generated figure. The cigarette demand file contains 48 states of data across 2 years. The data are stored inside the `Demos/Data` folder, so the document does not depend on paths outside this demo directory.

Figure 1 shows the relationship between cigarette taxes and per-capita cigarette consumption in 1995. The figure is generated from R code, but the code is hidden in the rendered paper because the output is meant to read like a manuscript rather than a coding worksheet.

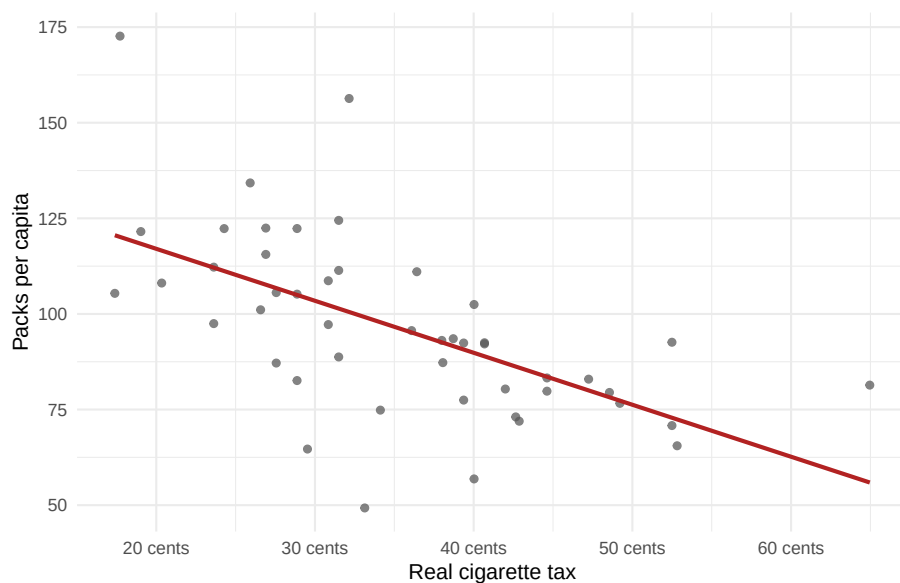


Figure 1: State cigarette taxes and cigarette consumption in 1995.

4 Discussion

The most important difference between a paper and a slide deck is not the code. It is the density of argument. A paper has to carry more explanation in prose, connect claims to evidence, and document sources through citations. Quarto supports that workflow while keeping the computational pieces close to the text.

For empirical political science, the same structure can scale from a short class handout to a full manuscript. A longer paper might add cross-references, tables, appendices, and a citation style file. The underlying pattern is the same: write in Markdown, cite from a `.bib` file, generate figures from code, and render to a stable output format.

References

- Anzia, Sarah F., and Molly C. Jackman. 2013. “Legislative Organization and the Second Face of Power: Evidence from u.s. State Legislatures.” *The Journal of Politics* 75 (1): 210–24.
- Cox, Gary W., and Mathew D. McCubbins. 1993. *Legislative Leviathan: Party Government in the House*. University of California Press.
- Cox, Gary W., and Mathew D. McCubbins. 2005. *Setting the Agenda: Responsible Party Government in the u.s. House of Representatives*. Cambridge University Press.
- Jenkins, Jeffery A., and Nathan W. Monroe. 2016. “On Measuring Legislative Agenda-Setting Power.” *American Journal of Political Science* 60 (1): 158–74.